

'I THINK IT'S HERE'

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SUNDAY, MAY 18, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Tribes fighting to remove pipeline

Fear consequences for Great Lakes as Trump fast-tracks Line 5

By **Adriana Pérez**
Chicago Tribune

Water is sacred and central to the way of life of Indigenous tribes in the Great Lakes region.

For generations, the interconnected streams, rivers and lakes have been a source of food, transportation, and cultural identity through ceremonies and traditions.

That is why they have been fighting for over a decade to remove the Line 5 pipeline not only from land they own but also from proximity to the life-giving watershed.

Line 5, owned by Calgary-based Enbridge, transports over 20 million gallons of crude oil and natural gas liquids from Wisconsin to Ontario each day via the Straits of Mackinac, which connect lakes Michigan and Huron. And each day, the pipeline's aging infrastructure and vulnerability to anchor strikes pose a risk to the drinking water of tens of millions in the Great Lakes region, according to activists and Indigenous communities.

"I always tell people that the Straits of Mackinac is like a heart attack waiting to happen, when we've already suffered all these other injuries and risks elsewhere along the line," said Whitney Gravelle, president of the Bay Mills Indian Community located in Michigan's Upper Peninsula, 50 miles north of the straits.

More than 1 million gallons of oil have reportedly spilled in the past 50 years along the pipeline's 645-mile route, though never at the straits. Experts say it's hard to quantify, or even imagine, the impact of that much oil spilled in varying quantities over such a long time. Operators are only required to report spills of a particular size or cost threshold.

Gravelle, who recently joined another Ojibwe tribal leader in Chicago to talk about their fight against Line 5, said a component of their resistance is rooted in tribal sovereignty.

"But if you pull the scope back, it's really about clean water," she said. "And for us to not respect

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'I WANT TO BE THERE FOR HIM'

Pope's friends, Catholic faithful from Chicago travel to Vatican for his inaugural Mass

By **Angie Leventis Lourgos**
Chicago Tribune

VATICAN CITY — After Chicago native Pope Leo XIV made history as the first American elected pontiff, the Rev. Homero Sánchez sent him a quick text saying, "Congratulations Holy Pope."

The priest from St. Rita of Cascia Parish on the city's Southwest Side went to bed that night not expecting an immediate reply from the newly selected leader of 1.4 billion Catholics worldwide — even if he had been his friend, mentor and Augustinian brother for the past 15 years.

Yet when Sánchez awoke around 1 a.m. Friday and reflexively checked his phone, there was a response.

Hours after Robert Francis Prevost was named the successor of St. Peter, the 267th pope texted Sánchez three emojis of hands pressed together in prayer, followed by a few words in Spanish that translated to "blessings, a hug."

"Honestly, the first thing I thought was 'that

Above: A photo of Pope Leo XIV is displayed in a shop window Friday near St. Peter's Square at the Vatican. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

INSIDE: Dolton mayor won't rule out public purchase of Pope Leo XIV's childhood home. **Chicagoland, Page 5**

can't be real," Sánchez said. "Just the fact that he replied made me think that he is still our brother.... Can you imagine? The pope is taking the time to acknowledge me."

Now Sánchez is elated to attend Pope Leo XIV's inaugural Mass in St. Peter's Square on Sunday, marking the official start of his papacy. He flew into Rome on Thursday and is staying with several other Chicago-area friends of the new pope who also made the journey.

"I want to be there for him," the priest said. "He needs our prayers."

Like Sánchez, many Chicago-area Catholics are making the nearly 4,000-mile pilgrimage to the Vatican to witness the inauguration Mass and other papal events this month, eager to celebrate one of their own rising to become Catholicism's spiritual leader.

Some travelers scrambled to book last-minute airfare and rapidly evaporating accommodations to attend the liturgical service, which

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Rep. Jackson rents office from business partner



U.S. Rep. Jonathan Jackson, center, talks with Rep. Jim Costa during a hearing of the House Agriculture Committee about the impact of economic policies on farm country on Feb. 11. **BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE**

Taxpayer dollars used for space at more than twice rate of past tenant

By **Chuck Neubauer** and **Sandy Bergo**
Chicago Tribune

U.S. Rep. Jonathan Jackson is spending federal tax dollars to rent a congressional district office on the South Side from his long-time business partner, powerful city developer Elzie Higginbottom, at more than twice the rate paid by the previous tenant.

Jackson last spring moved the district office into the first floor of a high-rise in the Theodore Lawless Gardens apartment complex that is owned and managed by Higginbottom. A Chicago political powerbroker who has been an ally of Illinois

governors and Chicago mayors for decades, Higginbottom is a close friend of the Jackson family, including the congressman's father, civil rights leader the Rev. Jesse Jackson.

The younger Jackson and Higginbottom have also been business partners for more than 27 years, according to land records and disclosure statements. The pair co-owns two South Side buildings they lease for grocery stores serving recipients of a federal program that helps pay for groceries for low-income mothers and their young children.

The partnerships that own the stores made Jackson more than \$100,000 in 2022 and between \$50,001 and \$100,000 the following year, according to Jackson's

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INSIDE



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Sox misplays help Cubs at Wrigley

The White Sox are making the Cubs look great by self-destructing in the City Series. Cubs win again, 7-3. **Paul Sullivan in Chicago Sports**

Severe storms kill dozens in 3 states

Kentucky bears brunt of pain with 18 deaths reported and a tornado that damaged homes and tossed vehicles. **Nation & World**

